E2 Speaking & Listening – ESB Exam Practice: Tasks 1–4

Name: _____ Date: _____

A. The exam – match the task to what you do

Task	What you do
Task 1 ___	a) You talk for about 2 minutes about a topic. Your partner listens and asks you 2 questions.
Task 2 ___	b) You ask and answer questions about your life with your partner and the examiner.
Task 3 ___	c) The examiner reads something. You answer questions. Then you discuss a topic in a group.
Task 4 ___	d) You talk about two pictures: what you can see, how they are different, and which one you prefer.

Tip: in Task 2 you get **1 minute to plan**. Always write short notes!

B. Task 1 – Personal information

1. Complete the questions. Use: **Where Do How Are did What**

a) _____ do you live?	I live in Hackney, near Mare Street.
b) _____ you work or study?	I study English at college.
c) _____ do you come to college?	By bus. It takes about 20 minutes.
d) _____ you married?	No, I'm not.
e) What _____ you do yesterday?	I went to the library with my friend.
f) _____ are your plans for the future?	I want to speak better English and study at Level 1.

2. Correct the mistakes. These sentences are from real exam answers.

Mistake	Correct sentence
a) Yesterday I went my uncle's house.	
b) My children they enjoyed very much.	
c) Last week I go to the park.	
d) We are very enjoy with our family.	
e) Where you live?	
f) What you did yesterday?	

3. Pairs. Ask your partner 4 questions from Part B. Write short notes.

Question	My partner's answer
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	

C. Task 2 – Talk for about 2 minutes

Choose one topic: 1) What you did last weekend. 2) A day out in London. Why did you like it? 3) What you like and don't like about your area. 4) A special meal. What did you eat? Who were you with? 5) Something you liked to cook in your country. 6) Your favourite TV programme. How often do you watch it?

1-minute planning notes (words only – no sentences!)

When?	
Where?	

Who with?	
What did you do? (3 things)	
How did you feel? Why?	

Useful words: First, … Then, … After that, … Finally, … It was … because …

Listener: write 2 questions for your partner. Start with **Did …? / What …? / Where …? / Who …?**

1. _____

2. _____

D. Task 3 – Two pictures

Describe	Compare	Say what you prefer
In picture A there is / there are … The man is …ing. I can see …	Picture A is bigger / busier / quieter than picture B. Picture B is more modern than picture A. … but …	I prefer picture … because … I would rather … because … I like … more than …

Write 2 sentences comparing one pair of pictures:

E. Task 4a – Listening (your teacher reads twice)

First listening. What is it about? Circle A, B or C.

A) a new library opening in Hackney B) free activities at a library in the holiday C) a library closing for repairs

Second listening. Answer the questions. Short answers are OK.

1. Which days can adults learn about computers?	
2. Who is the Tuesday activity for?	
3. What should adults take to the computer class?	
4. What time does the conversation club begin?	
5. How much do the activities cost?	
6. How can you get a place? Give one way.	

F. Task 4b – Group discussion

Topic: What can people do in London in their free time without spending much money?

Give your opinion	Bring other people in
I think … / In my opinion, … I agree with … because … I'm not sure. Maybe …	What do you think, …? Do you agree, …? Can I add something?

My checklist – tick what you did today

☐ I asked questions correctly (Do you…? Did you…?) ☐ I used the past tense for yesterday / last week

☐ I used my planning minute and wrote notes ☐ I compared the pictures and said what I prefer

☐ I asked other people in the discussion

Homework: choose a topic from Part C. Write notes and practise talking for 2 minutes. Record yourself on your phone and listen.